



Winsley Cricket Club Newsletter

May 2026

Winsley Cricket Club Centenary Season: Looking Back, Moving Forward

Celebrating a Century of Winsley Cricket Club

Welcome to the 2026 season! It marks 100 years since our re-founding, and there is much to celebrate and anticipate. A century ago, the village was much smaller, and the club played in modest, rustic surroundings, competing against neighbouring villages in the West Wiltshire area. Today, Winsley Cricket Club stands as one of the largest in the west country, offering cricketing opportunities to around 300 individuals, ranging from our youngest members aged five to our walking cricketers, some of whom are as old as eighty-nine. This remarkable growth is a testament to the dedication and contribution of countless individuals over the years.

More Than Just Cricket

It is easy to overlook that the true success of a club is not solely measured by achievements on the field, but by the opportunities it provides to both its members and the wider community. While there is always more to accomplish, Winsley is already recognised as a model club for the future of cricket, setting standards in inclusivity and community engagement.

A Landmark Year of Progress

This year promises to be exceptional as we build on our historic legacy and celebrate new milestones. Notably, our women's team has made its debut at the highest level in the WEPL Premier League. This weekend, we inaugurated our Southwick Cricket Partnership with the first match at our new second ground. In further groundbreaking news, we welcome Modester, our first female overseas player for the 2026 season, to the Winsley family. There is a palpable sense of excitement and anticipation, with every indication that we are set for a memorable season.

Preparations Behind the Scenes

Throughout the winter, our volunteers have worked tirelessly to ensure we are ready for the season ahead. We have introduced Club 365—so please do sign up if you have not already—to streamline our administrative processes. Our grounds staff have spent many long and chilly hours making sure both our grounds are in superb condition. The bar refurbishment is complete, and thanks are due to all those who contributed, ensuring that The Downs remains not only a venue for outstanding cricket but also a hub for social life within our community.

Centenary Events and Looking Forward

We have a host of events planned to mark our centenary year. Your support and involvement at these events are crucial, as we celebrate the rich history of Winsley Cricket Club and lay the foundation for continued growth into our second century.

Social events

Date	Organised by	Theme & dress	Food	Game
09 May	1 st XI	Sh*t Shirt Night	Chinese/curry	Bring a cricket themed item, if you match with someone you <u>have to</u> spin the forfeit wheel
30 May	1 st XI	90s night	Fish & chips	Karaoke 90s tunes
13 June	1 st XI	South African night	Braai	Something green
27 June	1 st XI	Drag Bingo	Food van	Theme cocktails, discounted Berries & Cherries
11 July	2 nd XI	80s night	tbc	
18 July	2 nd XI	Caribbean night	tbc	
8 Aug	3 rd /4 th XI	70s night	tbc	
15 Aug	3 rd /4 th XI	Australian night	tbc	
26 Aug	1 st XI	End of season, <u>whites</u> night	Curry	Live music tbc
11 Sep	Centenary Ball, Bath Spa Hotel			

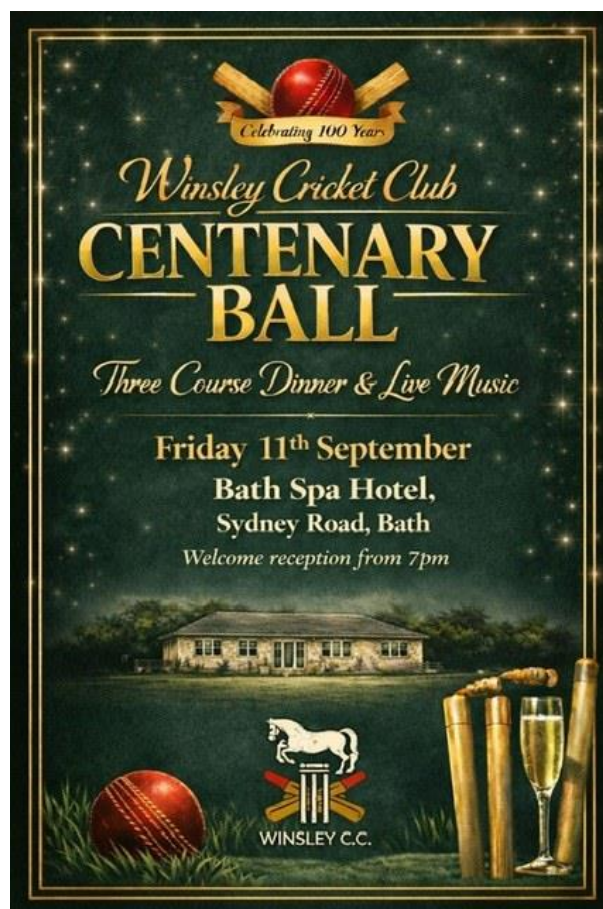
Throughout the season we are planning to “go back in time” for our socials, starting with 90’s and working our way back. Each team will be asked to take leadership of a couple of events, and we hope to create some fun socials for the Winsley CC community.

We will have competitions throughout the season alongside this:

- Best team song.
- Best social.
- Best dressed at the decade night cocktail named after them.
- Best karaoke performance.
- Total attendees at each social (on average).

Thanks, Josh Norgrove

Centenary Ball



Centenary celebrations kick off!

On 10th March 2026, over 20 players, members, families and supporters from the period in the club's history leading up to 1979 gathered in the Seven Stars for a buffet lunch to begin the centenary celebrations. "The Stars" has seen many raucous WCC nights over the years but this lunchtime gathering was a bit more sedate, probably a good thing!

Two players from the 1955 season joined us though, sadly, our longest serving player, from 1953, wasn't able to make it. The age range was from 62 to very nearly 90. Many happy

legendary club stories were relived – some might even have been true - and long term Winsley friendships renewed. The atmosphere was thick with nostalgia and laughter, as tales of epic victories and unforgettable moments echoed through the room, rekindling the spirit of the club's early days.

The age range was from 62 to very nearly 90.

We were fortunate to find in the archives newspaper records from the Wiltshire Times highlighting village fetes held at the ground in the 1950's and 60's, personal memorabilia showing significant events in our early days, photographs and also club accounts and old AGM records. Some items were available at the event and it was great to see the smiles widen on the faces of those remembering a very different club and village to what we see now. Each artefact seemed to unlock a flood of vivid memories, sparking lively conversations and even a few debates about the best era in club history and the comparison of players then and now.

Research also revealed that the relaunched 1926 club and its predecessors going back to 1890 used The Stars - that is 135 years of mutual support and what being part of a community is all about. The centenary gathering didn't just honour the past; it ignited a renewed sense of pride and excitement for the club's future, inspiring everyone to carry forward the legacy with gusto.

We have much to thank previous generations for so we will be hosting this group again, and similar others, at the ground over the summer to coincide with our other centenary events.





Profile: Modester Mupachikwa



Modester Mupachikwa is a distinguished Zimbabwean cricketer, celebrated for her skill and commitment to the sport. As a talented wicketkeeper and right-handed batter, Modester has represented Zimbabwe on the international stage, making significant contributions to the

women's national team. A mainstay of the national side since the age of 14, Modester is recognized as the most capped player in the history of Zimbabwe's women's national cricket. Her cricketing journey is marked by dedication, resilience, and a drive to elevate women's cricket in Zimbabwe and beyond.

International Career

Modester made her Women's Twenty20 International (WT20I) debut on January 5, 2019, against Namibia. She later earned her Women's One Day International (WODI) debut on October 5, 2021, facing Ireland. Her consistent performances have made her a cornerstone of the national team.

Playing Style

As a right-handed top-order batter, Mupachikwa is noted for her hard-hitting ability and consistent run-scoring, often opening the innings. Her skills as a wicketkeeper further enhance her value to the team, providing both batting strength and reliable fielding.

Domestic Career

Modester represents the Eagles in the Zimbabwean franchise system and, in 2022, signed with English club Spencer. Her experience in domestic leagues, both at home and abroad, has contributed to her growth as a player.

Recent Activity

As of early 2026, she has been active in Zimbabwe's tour of New Zealand and participated in the ICC Women's T20 World Cup Qualifier in January 2026.

Career Statistics (as of May 2026)

Format	Matches	Runs	High Score	Average	50s	Catches/Stumpings
WT20I	77	1,656	75*	28.55	4	33 / 13
WODI	30	670	77	23.10	4	22 / 2

Women's Premier League Debut

The League Season Commences

The senior Wiltshire League season began this weekend, marking an exciting time for our club. However, our women's team has already embarked on their competitive league journey. A week ago, they made their inaugural appearance in the WEPL Women's Premier League. This occasion was not only a proud day for everyone involved, but also a significant milestone in our club's history.

Strong Support and a Promising debut

The team enjoyed enthusiastic backing from families and club members, all gathered on a lovely day to witness this historic moment. Our women's side represented the club admirably, demonstrating skill and determination throughout the match. Although we missed out during the run chase against formidable opposition, Golden Hill, the performance proved that our team is capable of competing at this highest level. With the anticipated return of players from last season's championship squad, there is every confidence that we will continue to strengthen and grow.

Encouragement for Continued Support

Now playing at the top level of women's cricket in the region, our women's team would greatly appreciate your support. Attend their matches and witness first-hand the remarkable progress being made by each individual. This achievement is a fitting reward for the dedication shown by the players, their coaching staff, and their families over recent years.

For all this season's fixtures visit: [Winsley CC](#)

Thanks to Simon Howell for the photos.





Sponsorship Update

We've had fantastic uptake for our sponsorship packages over the last couple of months and it's been great to see so many local businesses, families, and members of the club's wider network come together to support Winsley CC financially.

As it stands we're on course to raise over £5,000 from our sponsorship activity this summer. Particular thanks must go to Cumberwell Park, Hartley Farm, and Tebb & Timber, all of which have contributed significant sums to support the 1st XI, All Stars, and 2nd XI respectively.

As the season kicks into gear you should start to see some new signage going up around the ground, as well as partner logos and information cropping up in the club's social media output as we get underway with our sponsorship activations. We are also keen to sell some of our remaining packages, with the women's team a particular focus in their first season in WEPL. Get in touch if you have any potential leads on that front.

As ever, if you have any ideas for sponsorship activity (or want to support the club through a sponsorship yourself) then feel free to contact me to discuss.

Go well, Chris Mann

We're recruiting for an exciting new centenary film project

We're excited to announce the Voices of Winsley CC film project as part of our centenary year celebrations. The project will celebrate our club community – capturing stories from the past and looking to the future - through a series of interviews. These will be shared on social media throughout the season and collated as an archive.

We're recruiting youth players from all age groups to carry out the (a) interviews and/or (b) editing; they will be trained and supported to do so in line with our safeguarding policies. It's a great way to learn some new skills.

We're also recruiting interviewees (past and present players, supporters, community members etc) – anyone who has stories to tell from the distant or near past or would like to reflect on how the club has evolved and what it means to them.

We will offer training for the youth interviewers/editors; filming will take place at the club during May. Travel expenses will be reimbursed. If you or your children would like to find out more and get involved, please contact Emily on 07905 888366 or siandm@sky.com.

Winsley CC history

Part One, the early days, 1926 – 1970

100 years ago, in April 1926, Winsley Cricket club was reformed at a meeting held in the old Social Club. Previously, an older club, Winsley and Turleigh CC had been founded in 1904 but seems to have disbanded around the time of the first world war.

The first ground, we believe, was not at our current home, The Downs, but for 10 years we played opposite the old Avon Park / Winsley FC ground on the "main road" to Limpley Stoke, playing in the West Wilts Cricket League until 1935. In 1936, courtesy of landlord, Mr Knatchbull, of the Winsley Manor, the club moved to the Downs, part of the land was fenced off and water laid to the square, plus in 1937, the first pavilion was erected. These facilities meant that Winsley was a successful local club leading up to the second world war. Local

derbies included matches against Freshford and Bradford, including one in which play was interrupted by snow in June!

In the early days, cricket was very different to today. The pitches were of basic quality where, sometimes six was awarded when the ball was lost in the long grass in the outfield. Even into the late 1960's players had to remove sheep poo from the ground before matches!

These facilities meant that Winsley was a successful local club leading up to the second world war.

The rustic conditions make it all the more remarkable that two players scored centuries "Gillie" Potter in 1938 and "Sam" Lucas in 1957. Also, during an illustrious career, fast bowler Mike Jones played between the 1950's and 80's and took over 1000 wickets. Many matches were "friendlies" (even against Bradford!) but the club did win the Trowbridge six-a-side competition in 1961.

In its early days the club was a true village institution and the hard work contributed by those first generations provided a sound basis for cricket to thrive in Winsley but also as a springboard for the amazing expansion of the club in the 1970's and subsequently, creating the success it is today.

Our centenary season will see many celebratory events but the focus will be the club's role in the community in the past, now and into the future. A programme of events will be published throughout the season here and on social media over coming weeks. Please get involved!





1979/80 Chippenham Indoor Knock Out Competition
Runners Up
K Potter B Fudge R Morrell
P Orchard J Swinburne N Swinburne

“Grandfather” of the club

Last week Jack Swinburne, our oldest living member, celebrated his 90's birthday. A past president, chair, secretary and 1st X1 captain, Jack also led the team which built the 1973 pavilion and has been a leading member of the club since 1970. Many happy returns Jack from us all!

